Portfolio Projects for BUSINESS COMMUNICATIONS

Chapter 9

Reports

NEW PERSPECTIVES

Objectives

- Identify report types
- Develop the report structure
- Develop the report content
- Add reference materials
- Add support materials
- Add a cover page in Word

Objectives (cont’d.)

- Insert a footnote in Word
- Insert a chart in Word
- Add captions to figures in Word
- Generate a table of figures in Word
- Customize a table of contents in Word

Introduction

- A report provides detailed information on a specific topic
- People use information to:
  - Support an existing decision
  - Help make a new decision
- Reports consist of multiple pages
- Steps:
  - Identify a purpose
  - Develop an outline
  - Gather content

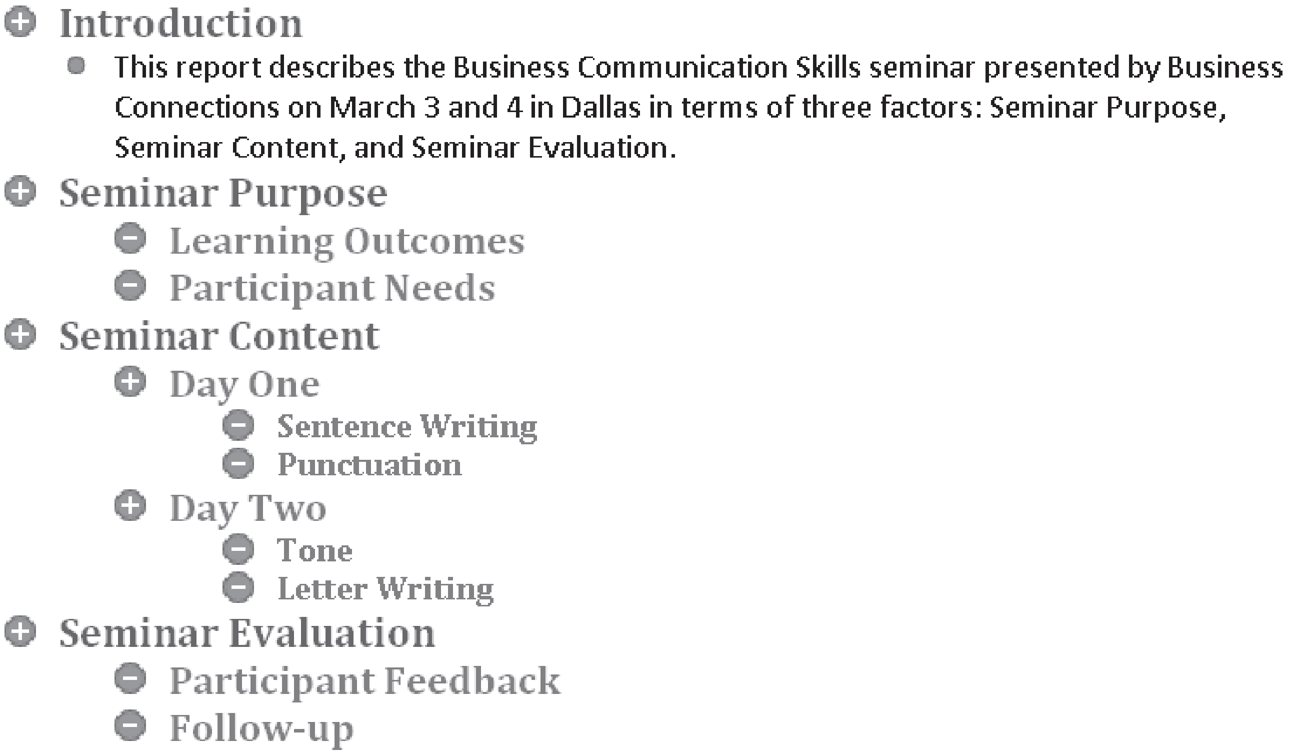
Report Essentials

- The word *report* describes a wide range of documents
  - Two-page memo or a 100 page annual report
- A report does not ask for something
  - Describes a situation and often recommends a specific course of action

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Identifying report types
  - Descriptive reports
    - Provides reader with information needed to understand a specific situation

Report Essentials (cont'd.)



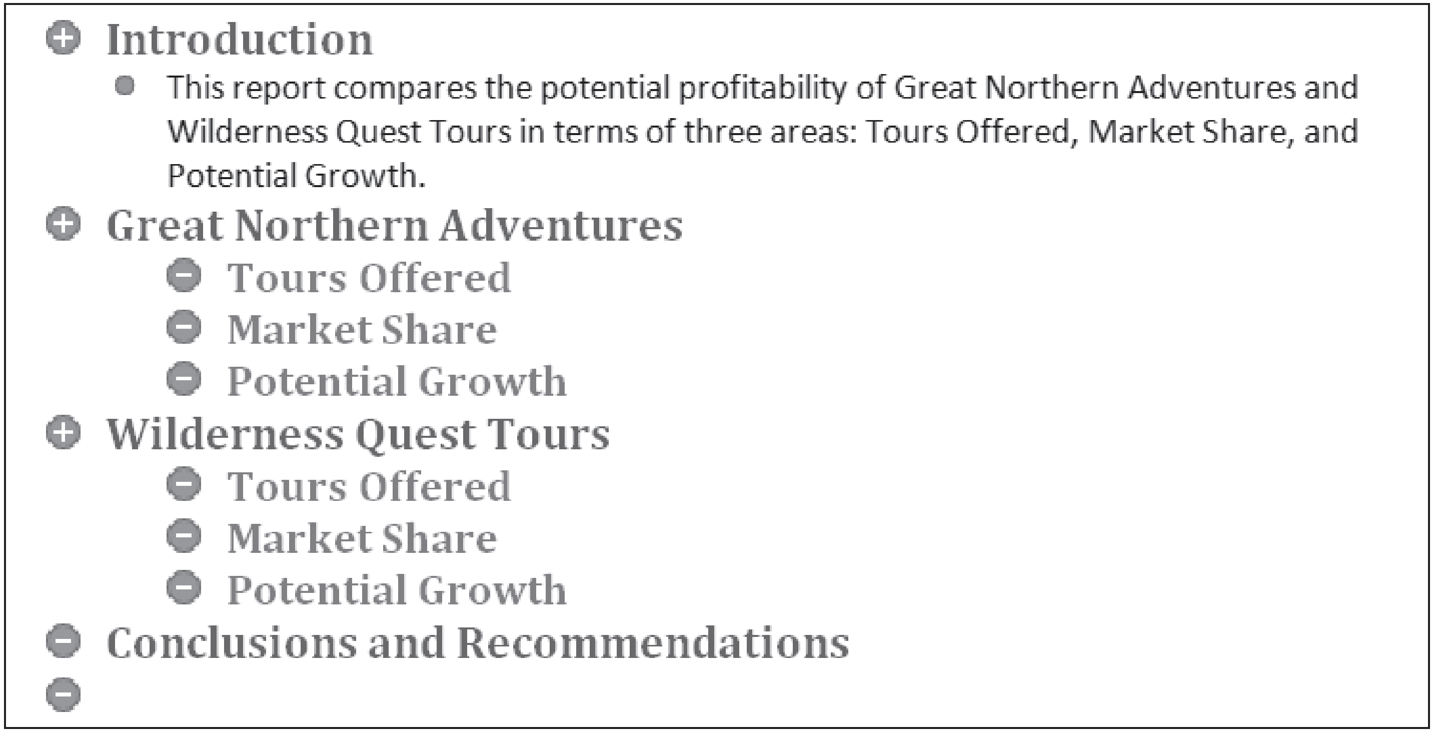
- Introduction
  - This report describes the Business Communication Skills seminar presented by Business Connections on March 3 and 4 in Dallas in terms of three factors: Seminar Purpose, Seminar Content, and Seminar Evaluation.
- Seminar Purpose
  - Learning Outcomes
  - Participant Needs
- Seminar Content
  - Day One
    - Sentence Writing
    - Punctuation
  - Day Two
    - Tone
    - Letter Writing
- Seminar Evaluation
  - Participant Feedback
  - Follow-up

Figure 9-1 Outline of a descriptive report

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Identifying report types (cont’d.)
  - Comparative reports
    - Compare two or more factors that a reader needs to evaluate
    - Presents a balanced view
    - Concludes with a recommendation regarding which brand to purchase
    - Also used to describe pros and cons

Report Essentials (cont'd.)



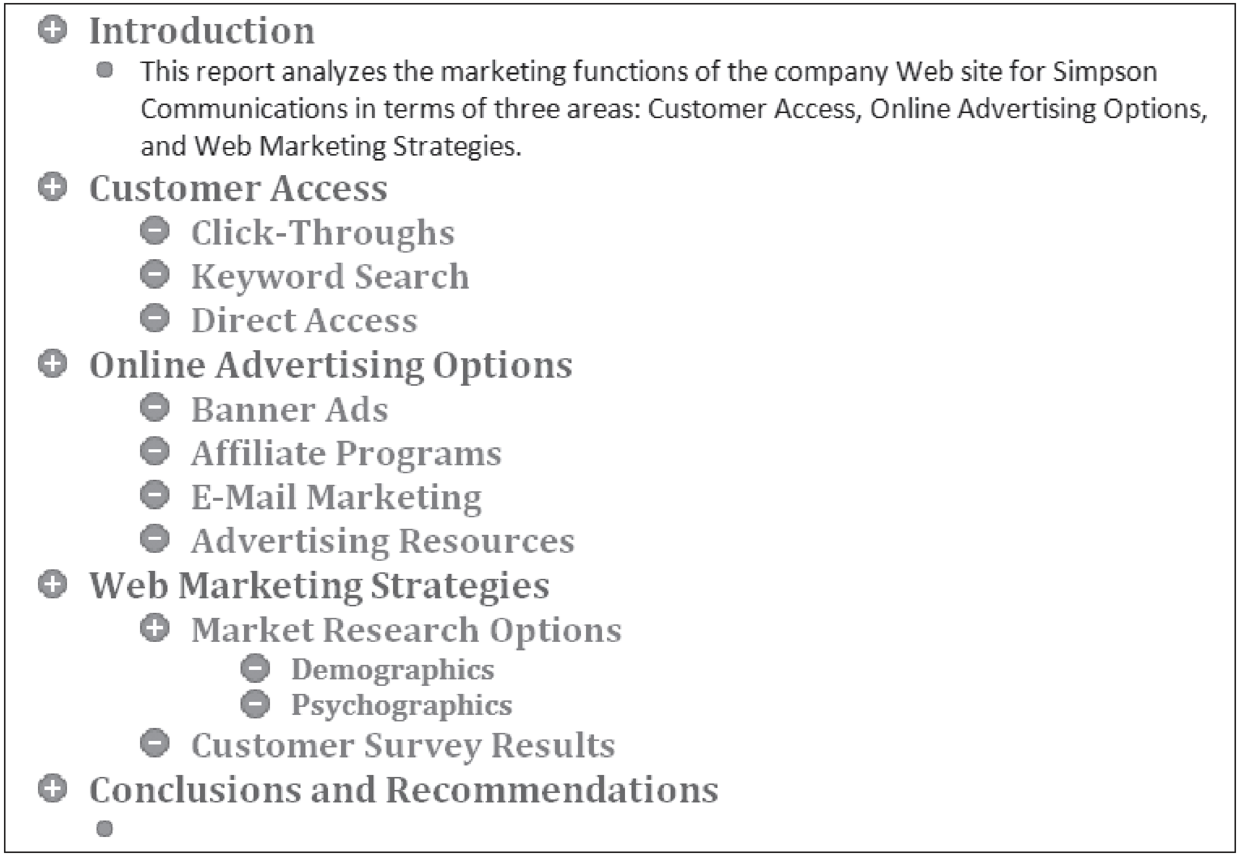
- Introduction
  - This report compares the potential profitability of Great Northern Adventures and Wilderness Quest Tours in terms of three areas: Tours Offered, Market Share, and Potential Growth.
- Great Northern Adventures
  - Tours Offered
  - Market Share
  - Potential Growth
- Wilderness Quest Tours
  - Tours Offered
  - Market Share
  - Potential Growth
- Conclusions and Recommendations

Figure 9-2 Outline of a comparative report

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Identifying report types (cont’d.)
  - Analytical reports
    - Provides an interpretation of factual information

Report Essentials (cont'd.)



- ⊕ Introduction
  - This report analyzes the marketing functions of the company Web site for Simpson Communications in terms of three areas: Customer Access, Online Advertising Options, and Web Marketing Strategies.
- ⊕ Customer Access
  - ⊖ Click-Throughs
  - ⊖ Keyword Search
  - ⊖ Direct Access
- ⊕ Online Advertising Options
  - ⊖ Banner Ads
  - ⊖ Affiliate Programs
  - ⊖ E-Mail Marketing
  - ⊖ Advertising Resources
- ⊕ Web Marketing Strategies
  - ⊕ Market Research Options
    - ⊖ Demographics
    - ⊖ Psychographics
  - ⊖ Customer Survey Results
- ⊕ Conclusions and Recommendations
  -

Figure 9-3 Outline of an analytical report

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Identifying report types (cont'd.)
  - Descriptive report: you want the reader to take note of information and perhaps use it to support the next step
  - Comparative report: you want the reader to compare two or more products, services, or scenarios to make an informed decision based on certain criteria
  - Analytical report: you want to provide the reader with a description of a current situation and your interpretation

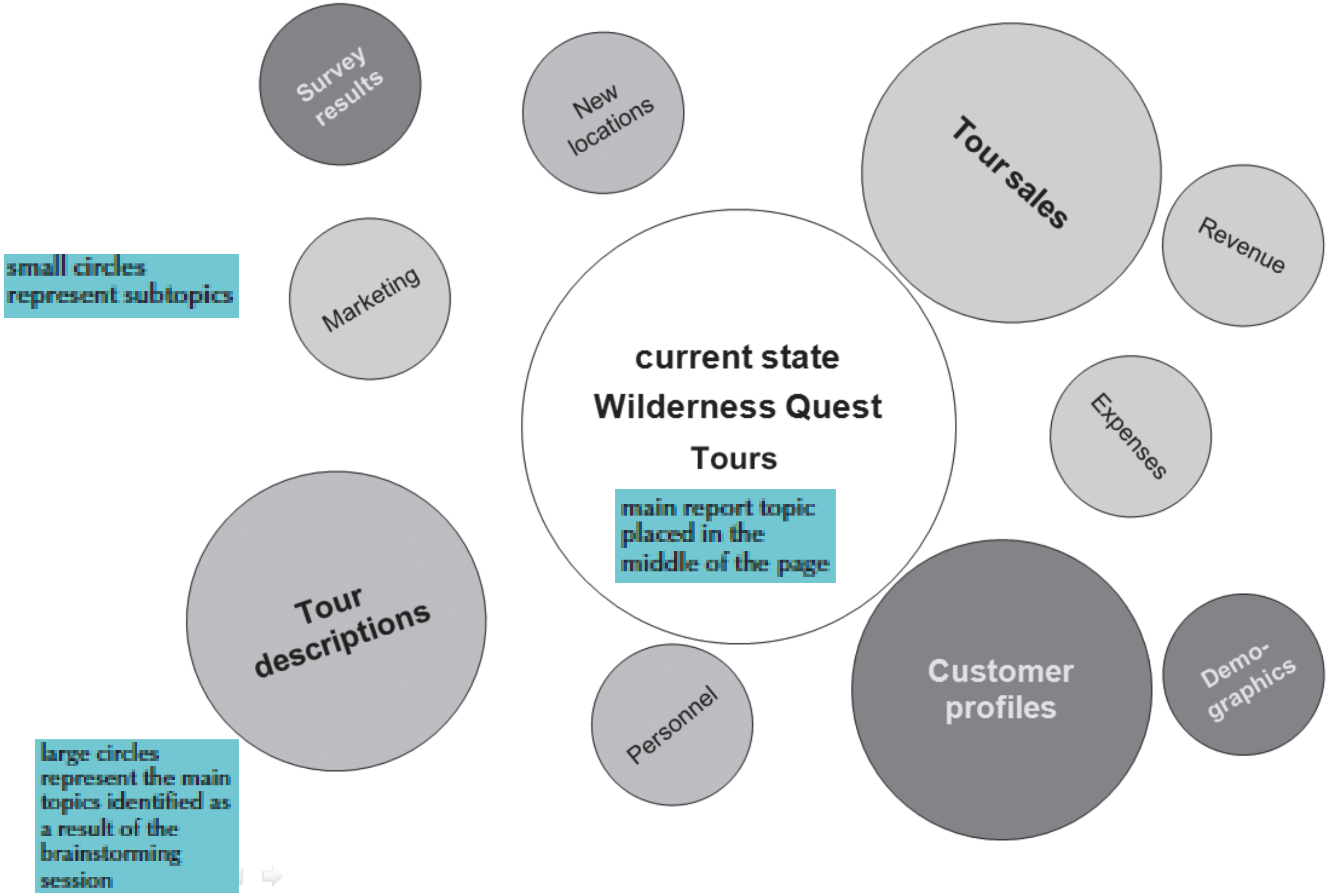
Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Developing the report structure
    1. Identify main topics
    2. Write a core sentence
    3. Develop an outline

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Developing the report structure (cont'd.)
  - Identify main topics
    - Report backbone
    - Gives reader a sense of overall structure
    - Mistake: people choose topics that are too large
    - Brainstorm

Report Essentials (cont'd.)


Survey results
New locations
Tour sales
Revenue
Marketing
current state Wilderness Quest Tours
Expenses
Tour descriptions
Personnel
Customer profiles
Demo-graphics

small circles represent subtopics

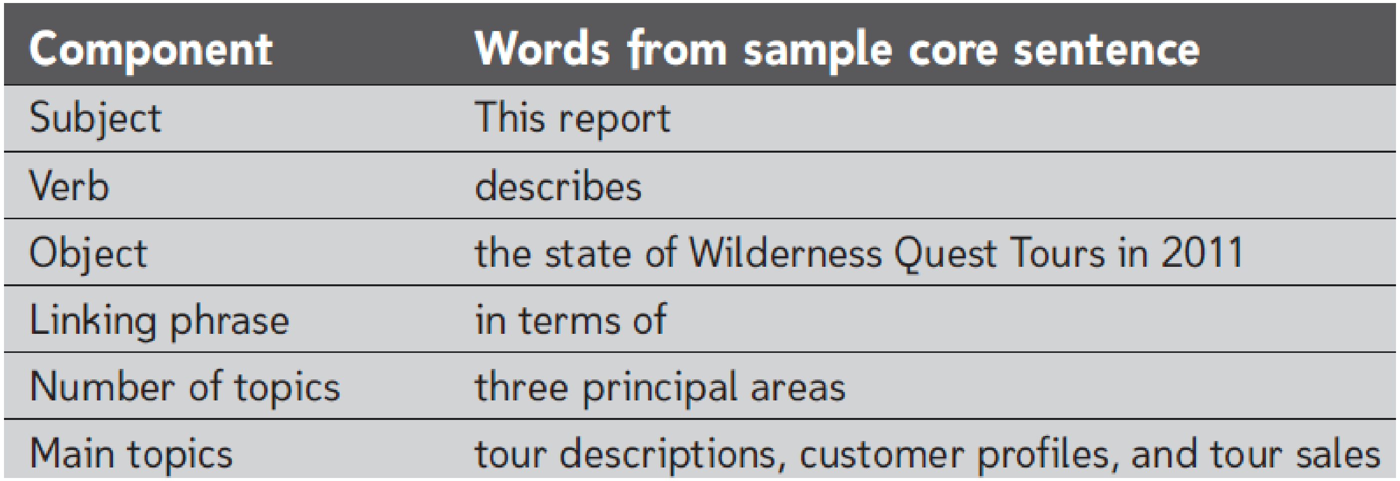
main report topic placed in the middle of the page

large circles represent the main topics identified as a result of the brainstorming session

Figure 9-4 Sample brainstorming session

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Developing the report structure (cont'd.)
  - Write a core sentence
    - Presents topics of your report, along with two or three principal subtopics



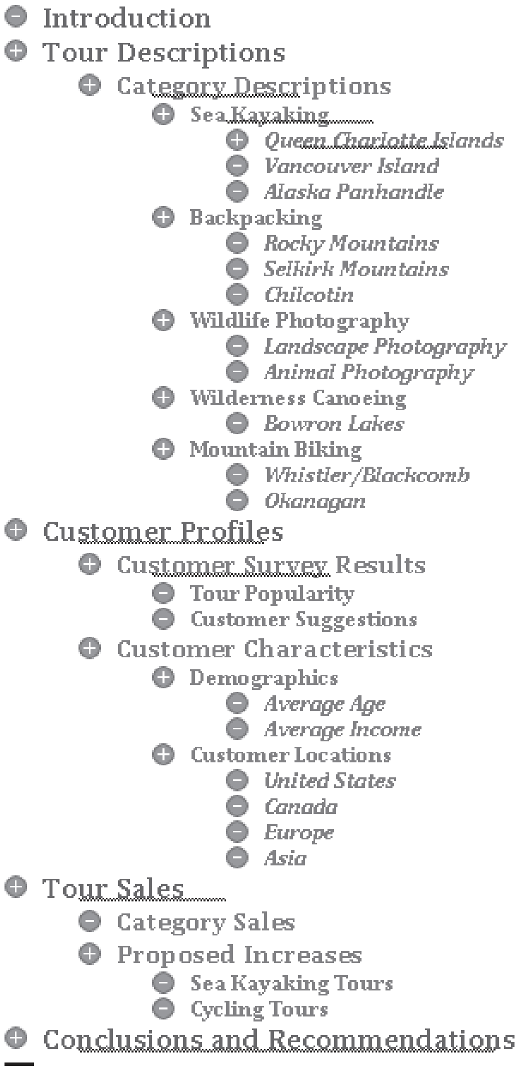
Component	Words from sample core sentence
Subject	This report
Verb	describes
Object	the state of Wilderness Quest Tours in 2011
Linking phrase	in terms of
Number of topics	three principal areas
Main topics	tour descriptions, customer profiles, and tour sales

Figure 9-5 Sample core sentence

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Developing the report structure (cont'd.)
  - Develop an outline
    - Effective outline includes several layers of subtopics
    - You can work in Outline view in Word to develop the sequence of topics and subtopics

Report Essentials (cont'd.)



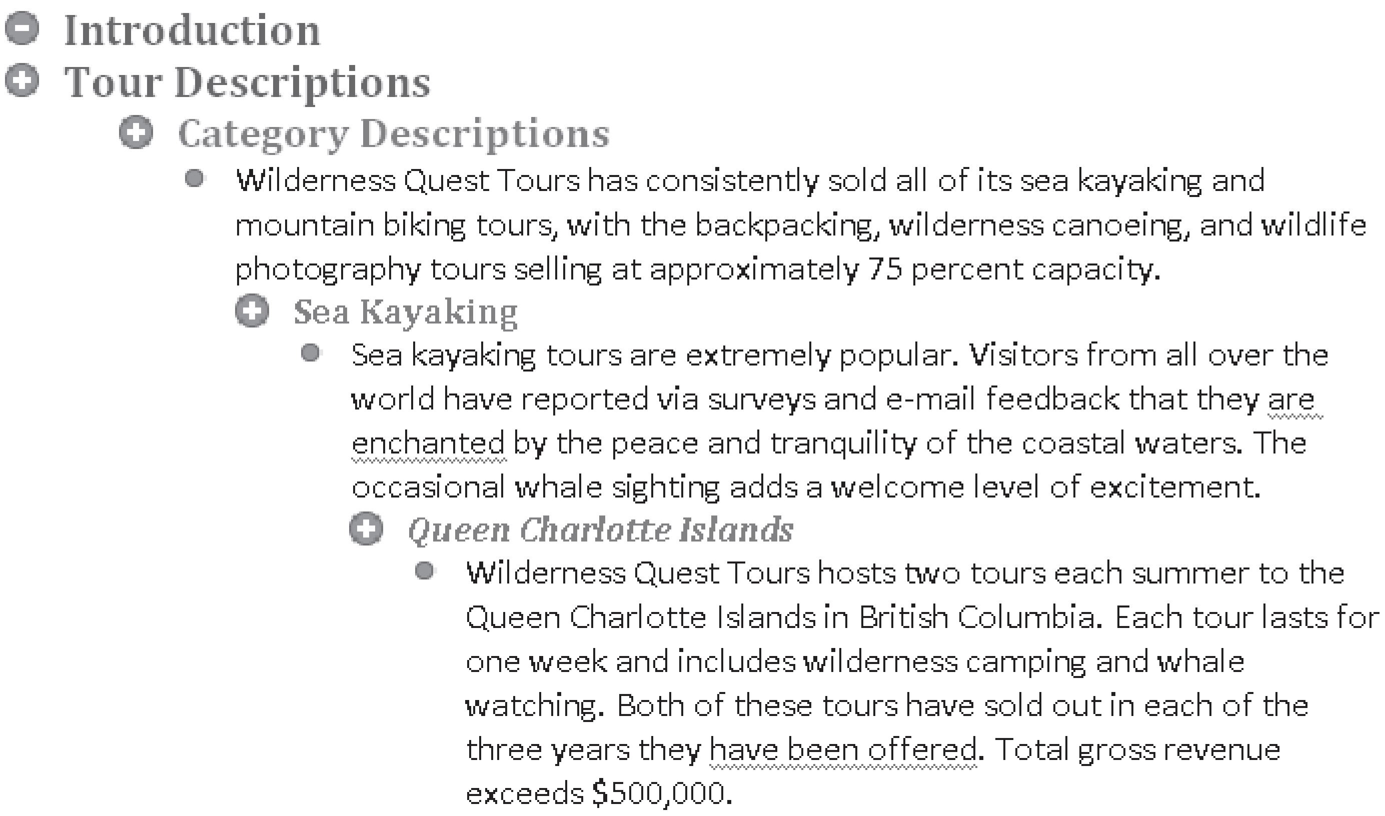
- ⊖ Introduction
- ⊕ Tour Descriptions
  - ⊕ Category Descriptions
    - ⊕ Sea Kayaking
      - ⊕ *Queen Charlotte Islands*
      - ⊖ *Vancouver Island*
      - ⊖ *Alaska Panhandle*
    - ⊕ Backpacking
      - ⊖ *Rocky Mountains*
      - ⊖ *Selkirk Mountains*
      - ⊖ *Chilcotin*
    - ⊕ Wildlife Photography
      - ⊖ *Landscape Photography*
      - ⊖ *Animal Photography*
    - ⊕ Wilderness Canoeing
      - ⊖ *Bowron Lakes*
    - ⊕ Mountain Biking
      - ⊖ *Whistler/Blackcomb*
      - ⊖ *Okanagan*
- ⊕ Customer Profiles
  - ⊕ Customer Survey Results
    - ⊖ Tour Popularity
    - ⊖ Customer Suggestions
  - ⊕ Customer Characteristics
    - ⊕ Demographics
      - ⊖ *Average Age*
      - ⊖ *Average Income*
    - ⊕ Customer Locations
      - ⊖ *United States*
      - ⊖ *Canada*
      - ⊖ *Europe*
      - ⊖ *Asia*
- ⊕ Tour Sales
  - ⊖ Category Sales
  - ⊕ Proposed Increases
    - ⊖ Sea Kayaking Tours
    - ⊖ Cycling Tours
- ⊕ Conclusions and Recommendations

Figure 9-6 Sample outline in Outline view

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Developing report content
  - Outline keeps you on track and focused
  - Gather only content required to expand on topics and subtopics in the outline

Report Essentials (cont’d.)



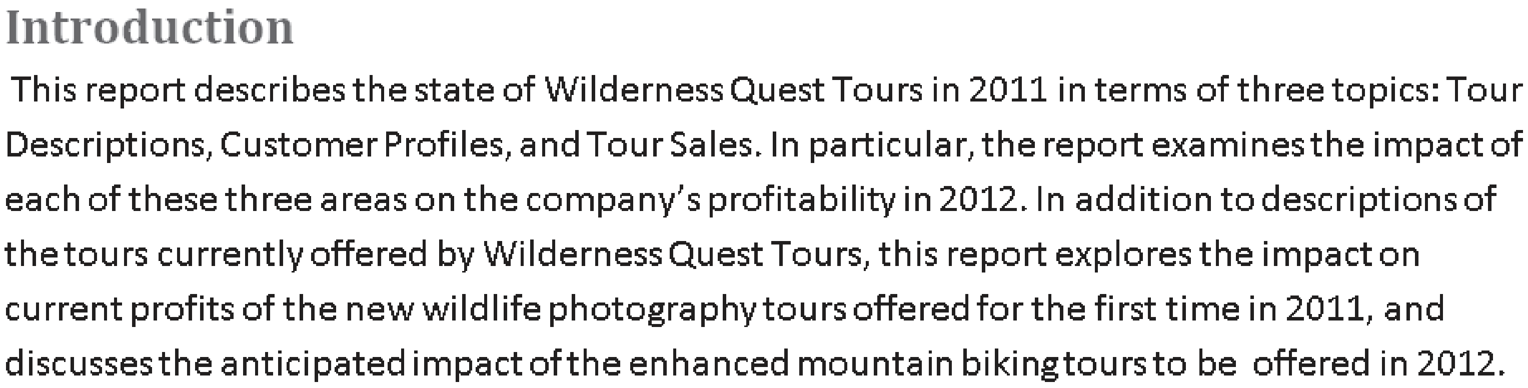
- ⊖ **Introduction**
- ⊕ **Tour Descriptions**
  - ⊕ **Category Descriptions**
    - Wilderness Quest Tours has consistently sold all of its sea kayaking and mountain biking tours, with the backpacking, wilderness canoeing, and wildlife photography tours selling at approximately 75 percent capacity.
    - ⊕ **Sea Kayaking**
      - Sea kayaking tours are extremely popular. Visitors from all over the world have reported via surveys and e-mail feedback that they are enchanted by the peace and tranquility of the coastal waters. The occasional whale sighting adds a welcome level of excitement.
      - ⊕ ***Queen Charlotte Islands***
        - Wilderness Quest Tours hosts two tours each summer to the Queen Charlotte Islands in British Columbia. Each tour lasts for one week and includes wilderness camping and whale watching. Both of these tours have sold out in each of the three years they have been offered. Total gross revenue exceeds $500,000.

Figure 9-7 Adding content in Outline view

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Developing report content (cont’d.)
  - Report introduction
    - Includes core sentence, description of reason for writing the report, and background information the reader might require to understand content

Report Essentials (cont’d.)



Introduction

This report describes the state of Wilderness Quest Tours in 2011 in terms of three topics: Tour Descriptions, Customer Profiles, and Tour Sales. In particular, the report examines the impact of each of these three areas on the company’s profitability in 2012. In addition to descriptions of the tours currently offered by Wilderness Quest Tours, this report explores the impact on current profits of the new wildlife photography tours offered for the first time in 2011, and discusses the anticipated impact of the enhanced mountain biking tours to be offered in 2012.

Figure 9-8 Report introduction

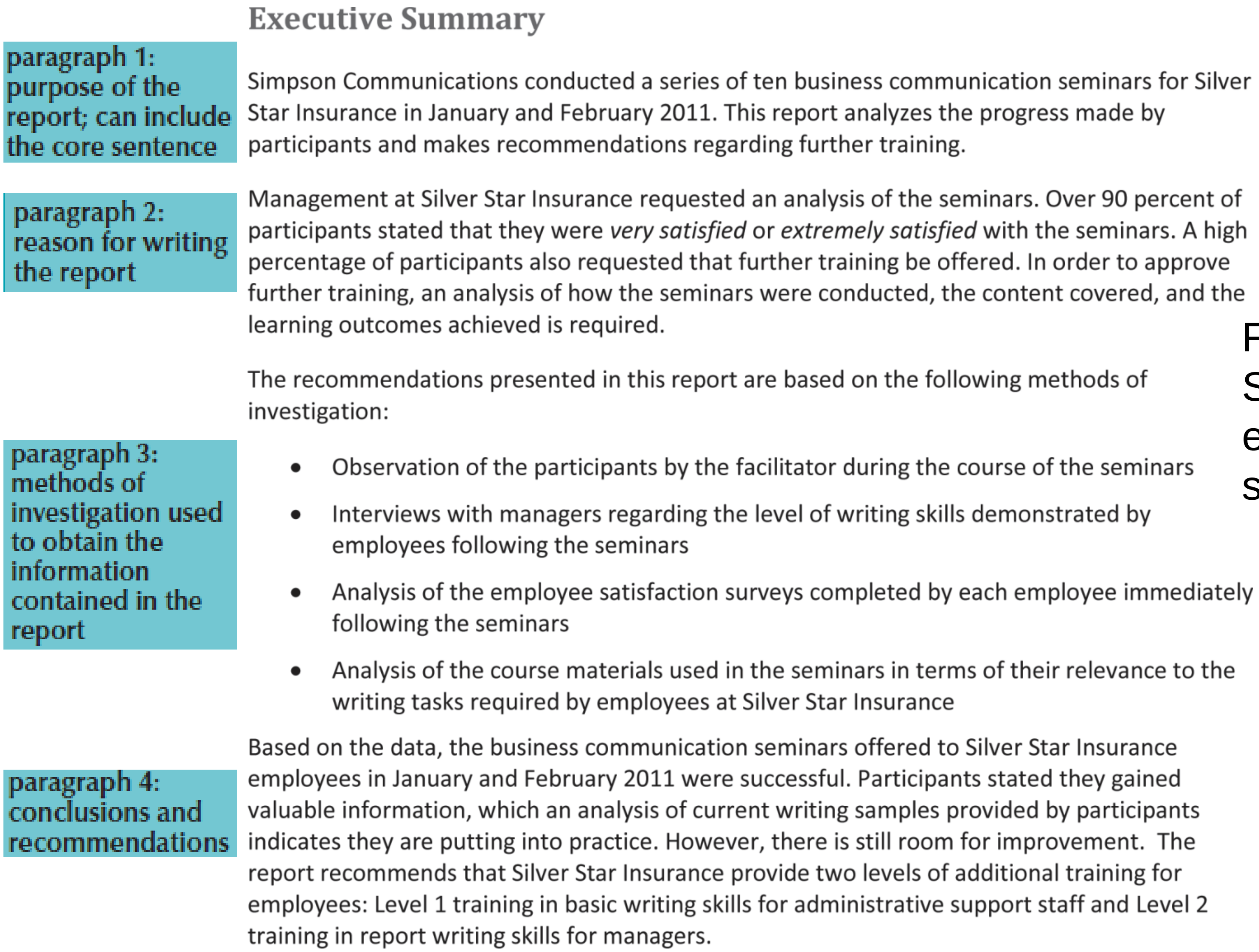
Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Developing report content (cont’d.)
  - Report writing process
    - Reports can be written sequentially or content can be added as collected
    - Outline view allows either
    - Write report content quickly and without worrying about errors, writing style, and formatting
    - Then go back and edit

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Developing report content (cont'd.)
  - Report executive summary
    - Provides readers with a brief overview of contents and summarizes recommendations
  - Four parts:
    - Purpose of the report
    - Reason for writing the report
    - Methods of investigation used to obtain information
    - Conclusions and recommendations

Report Essentials (cont'd.)



Executive Summary

paragraph 1: purpose of the report; can include the core sentence

Simpson Communications conducted a series of ten business communication seminars for Silver Star Insurance in January and February 2011. This report analyzes the progress made by participants and makes recommendations regarding further training.

paragraph 2: reason for writing the report

Management at Silver Star Insurance requested an analysis of the seminars. Over 90 percent of participants stated that they were *very satisfied* or *extremely satisfied* with the seminars. A high percentage of participants also requested that further training be offered. In order to approve further training, an analysis of how the seminars were conducted, the content covered, and the learning outcomes achieved is required.

paragraph 3: methods of investigation used to obtain the information contained in the report

The recommendations presented in this report are based on the following methods of investigation:

- Observation of the participants by the facilitator during the course of the seminars
- Interviews with managers regarding the level of writing skills demonstrated by employees following the seminars
- Analysis of the employee satisfaction surveys completed by each employee immediately following the seminars
- Analysis of the course materials used in the seminars in terms of their relevance to the writing tasks required by employees at Silver Star Insurance

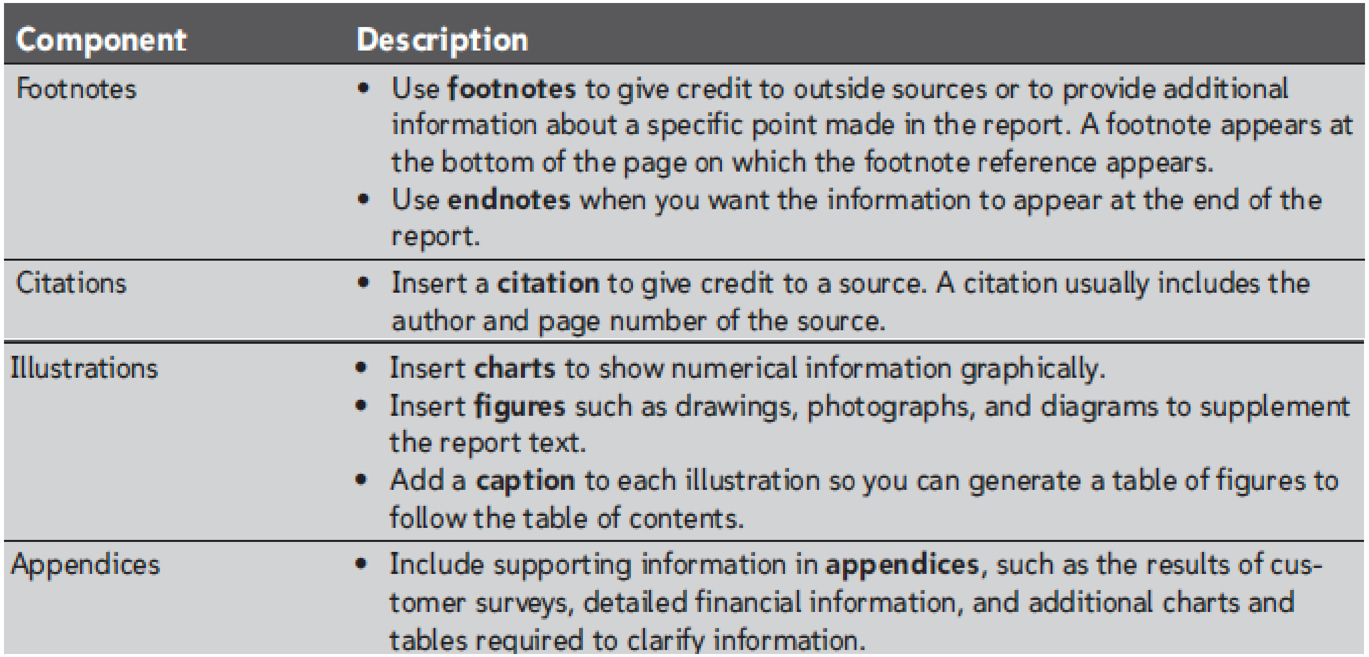
paragraph 4: conclusions and recommendations

Based on the data, the business communication seminars offered to Silver Star Insurance employees in January and February 2011 were successful. Participants stated they gained valuable information, which an analysis of current writing samples provided by participants indicates they are putting into practice. However, there is still room for improvement. The report recommends that Silver Star Insurance provide two levels of additional training for employees: Level 1 training in basic writing skills for administrative support staff and Level 2 training in report writing skills for managers.

Figure 9-9
Sample executive summary

Report Essentials (cont’d.)

- Developing report content (cont’d.)
  - Adding reference materials
    - Give credit to sources using footnotes or citations

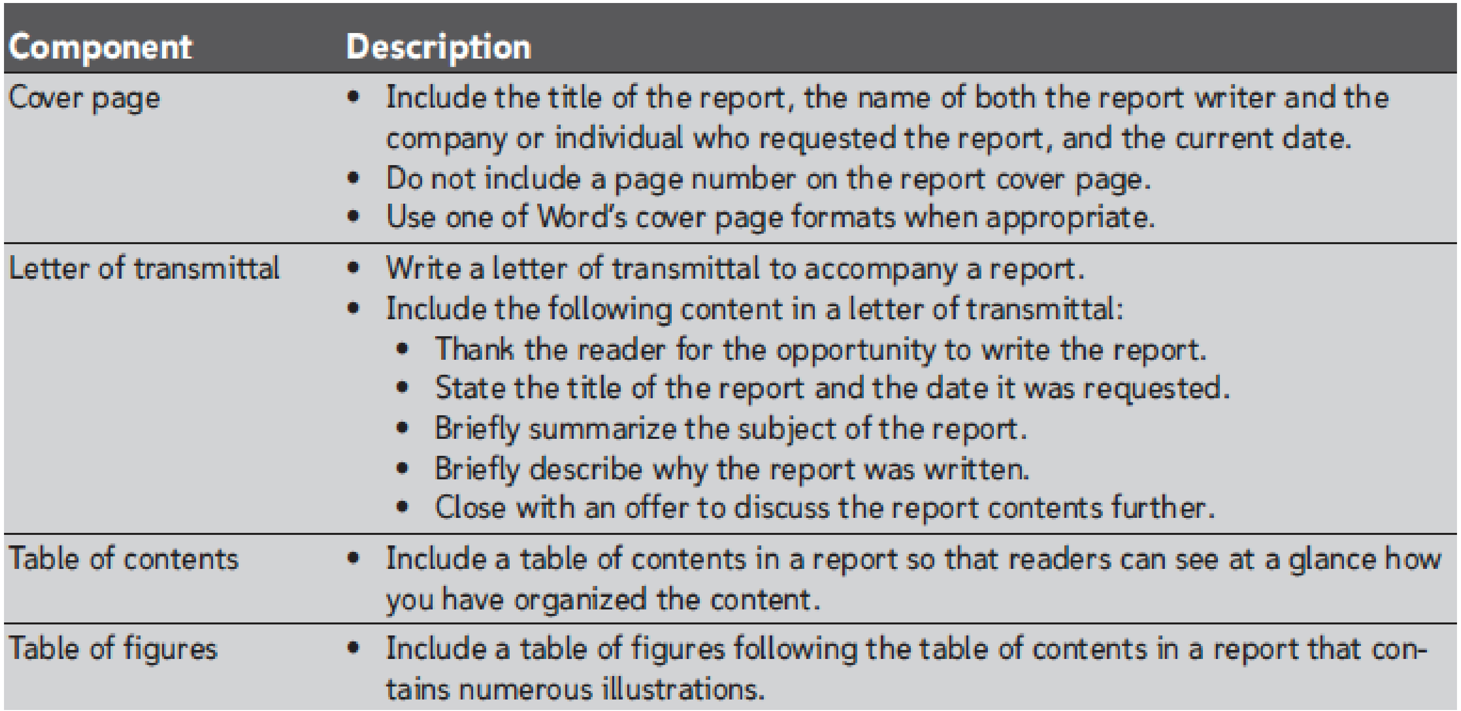


Component	Description
Footnotes	• Use **footnotes** to give credit to outside sources or to provide additional information about a specific point made in the report. A footnote appears at the bottom of the page on which the footnote reference appears. • Use **endnotes** when you want the information to appear at the end of the report.
Citations	• Insert a **citation** to give credit to a source. A citation usually includes the author and page number of the source.
Illustrations	• Insert **charts** to show numerical information graphically. • Insert **figures** such as drawings, photographs, and diagrams to supplement the report text. • Add a **caption** to each illustration so you can generate a table of figures to follow the table of contents.
Appendices	• Include supporting information in **appendices**, such as the results of customer surveys, detailed financial information, and additional charts and tables required to clarify information.

Figure 9-10 Reference materials in reports

Report Essentials (cont'd.)

- Developing report content (cont'd.)
  - Adding support materials



Component	Description
Cover page	• Include the title of the report, the name of both the report writer and the company or individual who requested the report, and the current date. • Do not include a page number on the report cover page. • Use one of Word's cover page formats when appropriate.

Letter of transmittal	• Write a letter of transmittal to accompany a report.
	• Include the following content in a letter of transmittal:
	  • Thank the reader for the opportunity to write the report.
	  • State the title of the report and the date it was requested.
	  • Briefly summarize the subject of the report.
	  • Briefly describe why the report was written.
	  • Close with an offer to discuss the report contents further.

Table of contents	• Include a table of contents in a report so that readers can see at a glance how you have organized the content.
Table of figures	• Include a table of figures following the table of contents in a report that contains numerous illustrations.

Figure 9-11 Support materials for reports

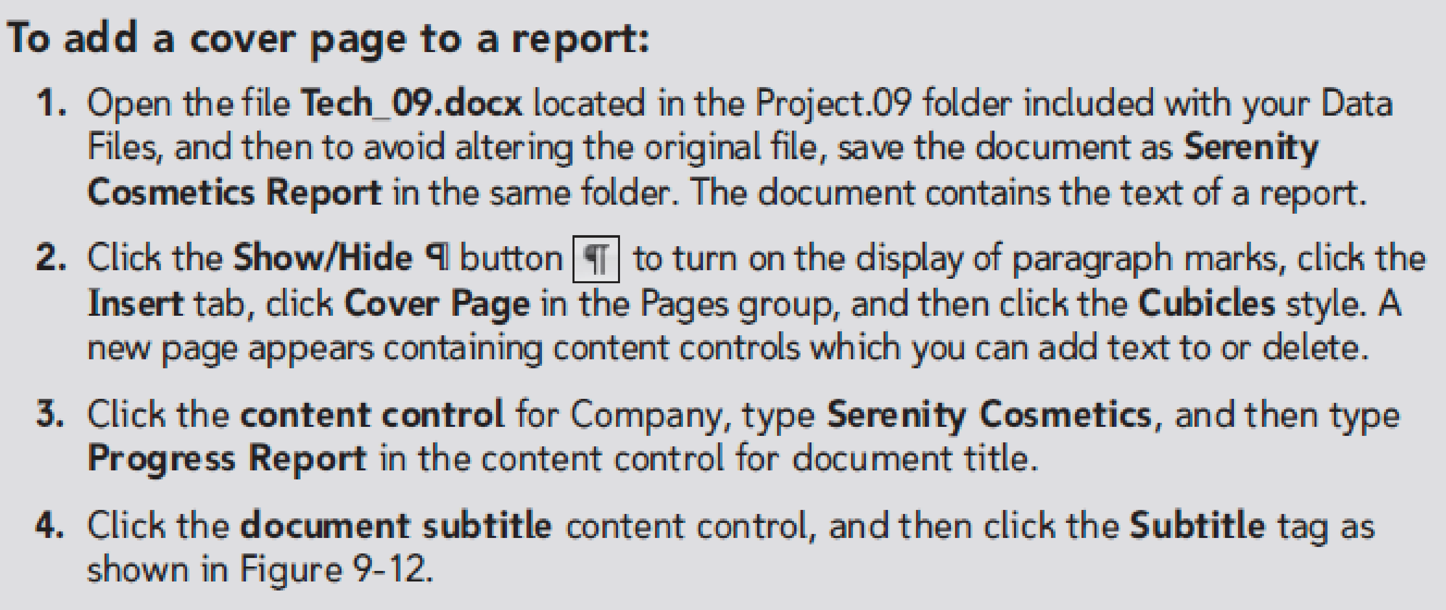
Technology Skills Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents

- In Word, you can enhance a multiple-page document by:
  - Adding a cover page
  - Inserting footnotes
  - Inserting a chart
  - Adding captions to figures
  - Generating a table of figures
  - Modifying a table of contents to include more than three heading levels

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)

- You can create a cover page in Word that includes placeholders for variable information
- Word includes a variety of formats for cover pages that add a professional look

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont'd.)



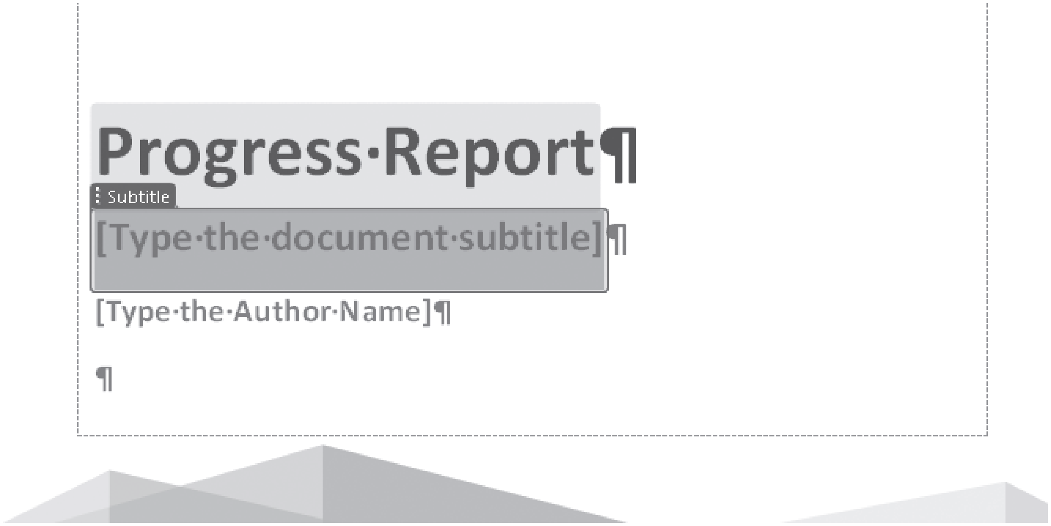
To add a cover page to a report:

1. Open the file **Tech_09.docx** located in the Project.09 folder included with your Data Files, and then to avoid altering the original file, save the document as **Serenity Cosmetics Report** in the same folder. The document contains the text of a report.
2. Click the **Show/Hide ¶** button ¶ to turn on the display of paragraph marks, click the **Insert** tab, click **Cover Page** in the Pages group, and then click the **Cubicles** style. A new page appears containing content controls which you can add text to or delete.
3. Click the **content control** for Company, type **Serenity Cosmetics**, and then type **Progress Report** in the content control for document title.
4. Click the **document subtitle** content control, and then click the **Subtitle** tag as shown in Figure 9-12.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont'd.)

Subtitle tag turns dark blue when selected

author content control; a name may appear here



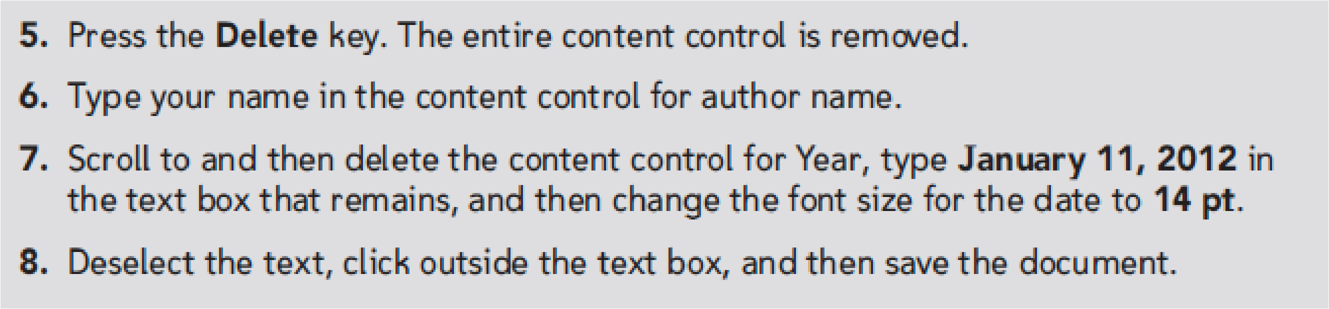
Progress·Report¶

[Type·the·document·subtitle]¶

[Type·the·Author·Name]¶

¶

Figure 9-12 Subtitle content control tag selected

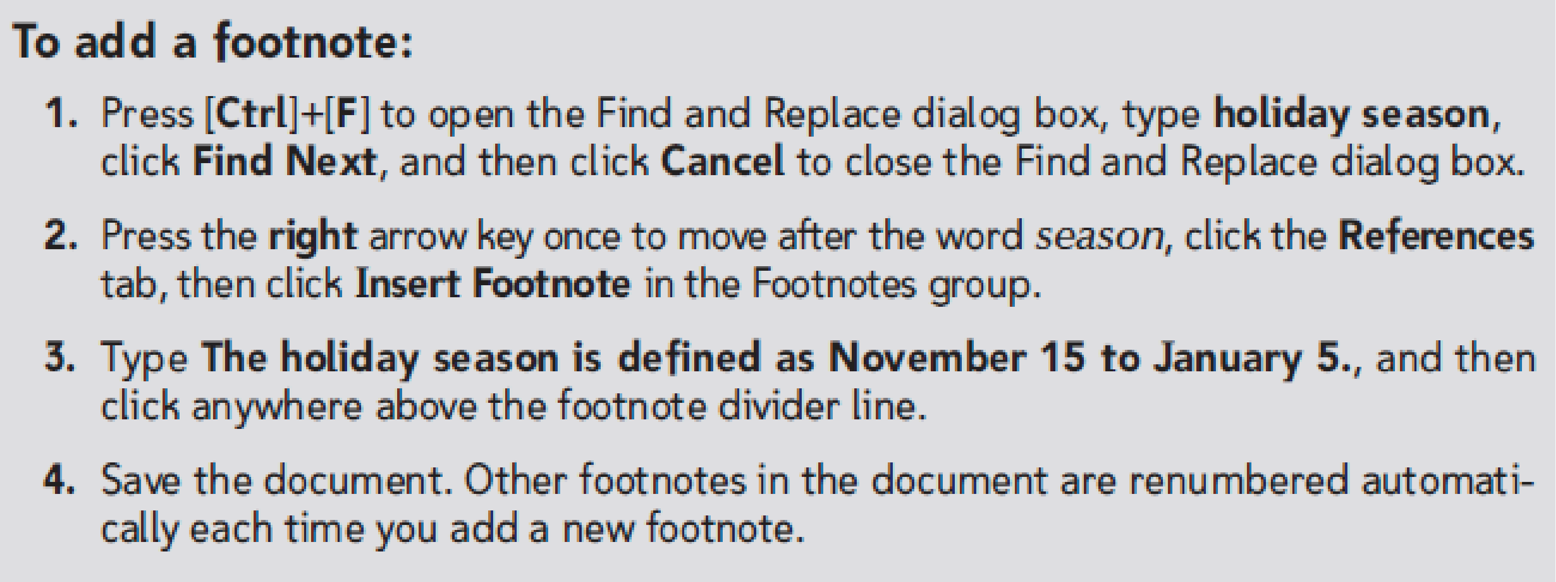


5. Press the **Delete** key. The entire content control is removed.
6. Type your name in the content control for author name.
7. Scroll to and then delete the content control for Year, type **January 11, 2012** in the text box that remains, and then change the font size for the date to **14 pt**.
8. Deselect the text, click outside the text box, and then save the document.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)

- Footnote command gives credit to references made in report body
  - You can also insert a footnote to provide additional information about a specific point made
  - When you insert a footnote, footnote text is entered at the bottom of the page
  - Endnotes appear together at the end of a document

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)



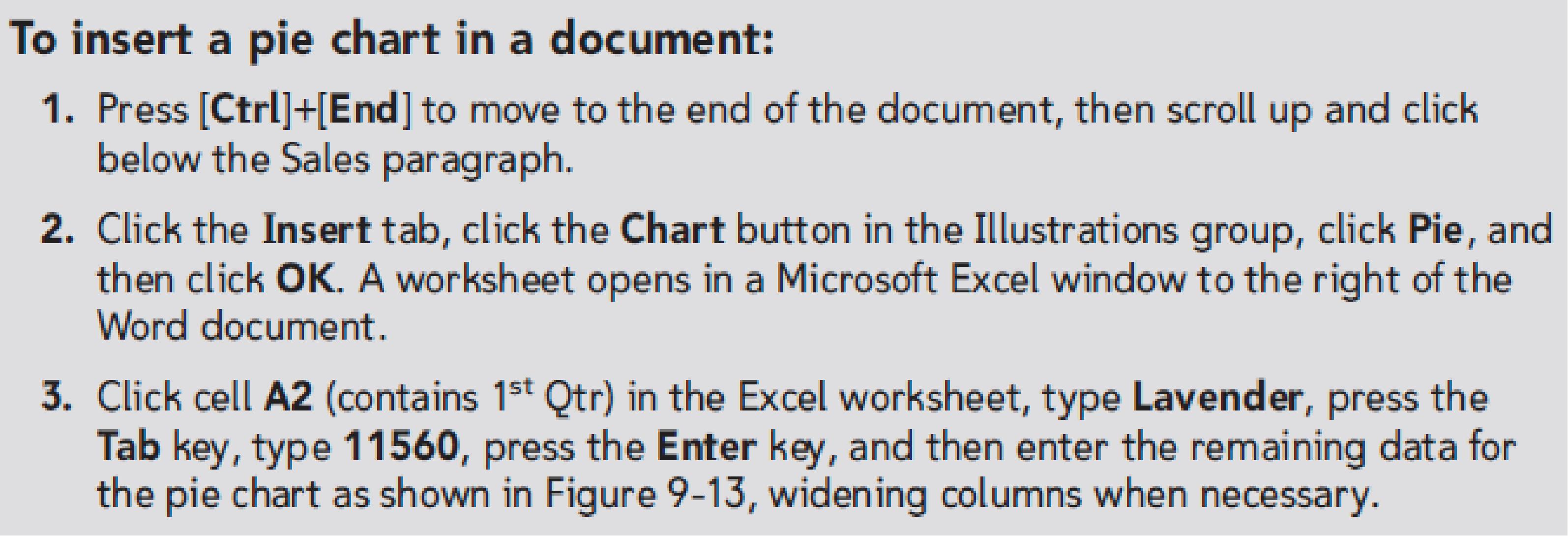
To add a footnote:

1. Press [**Ctrl**]+[**F**] to open the Find and Replace dialog box, type **holiday season**, click **Find Next**, and then click **Cancel** to close the Find and Replace dialog box.
2. Press the **right** arrow key once to move after the word *season*, click the **References** tab, then click **Insert Footnote** in the Footnotes group.
3. Type **The holiday season is defined as November 15 to January 5.**, and then click anywhere above the footnote divider line.
4. Save the document. Other footnotes in the document are renumbered automatically each time you add a new footnote.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont'd.)

- Long documents often include figures containing charts, diagrams, and other illustrations
- You can copy a chart from an Excel workbook or you can create a chart in a Word document

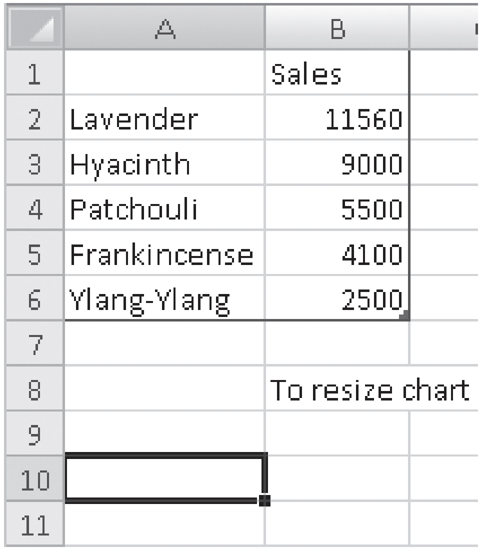
Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)



To insert a pie chart in a document:

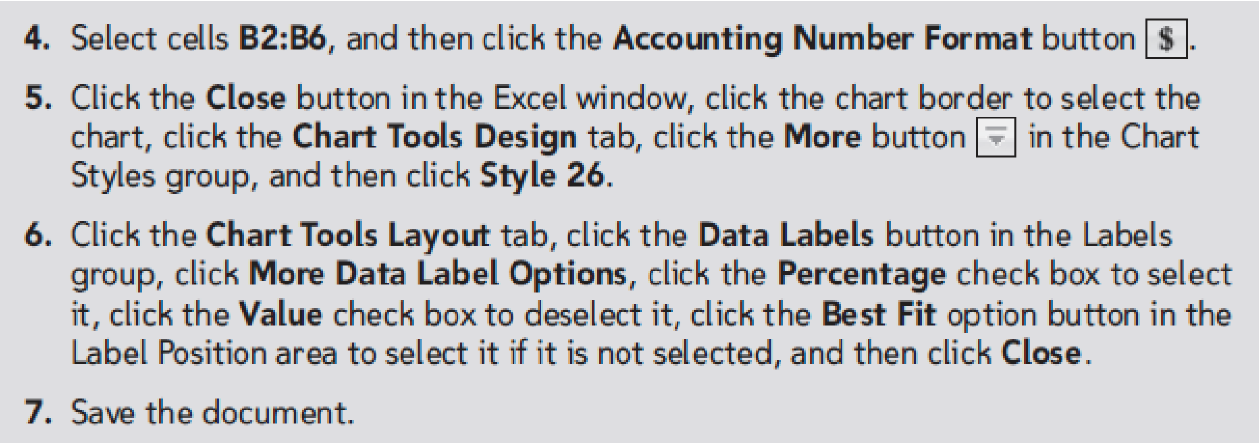
1. Press [**Ctrl**]+[**End**] to move to the end of the document, then scroll up and click below the Sales paragraph.
2. Click the **Insert** tab, click the **Chart** button in the Illustrations group, click **Pie**, and then click **OK**. A worksheet opens in a Microsoft Excel window to the right of the Word document.
3. Click cell **A2** (contains 1st Qtr) in the Excel worksheet, type **Lavender**, press the **Tab** key, type **11560**, press the **Enter** key, and then enter the remaining data for the pie chart as shown in Figure 9-13, widening columns when necessary.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)



	A	B
1		Sales
2	Lavender	11560
3	Hyacinth	9000
4	Patchouli	5500
5	Frankincense	4100
6	Ylang-Ylang	2500
7		
8		To resize chart
9		
10		
11		

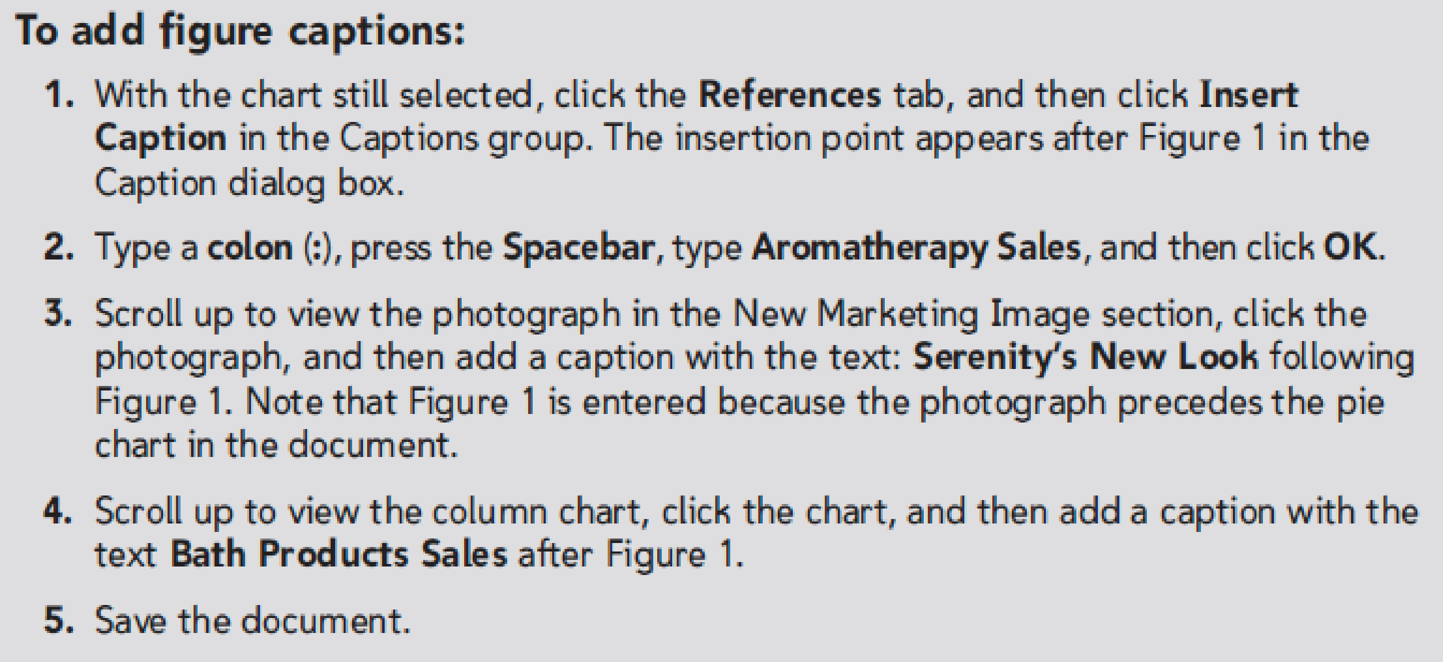
Figure 9-13
Pie chart data



4. Select cells **B2:B6**, and then click the **Accounting Number Format** button $.
5. Click the **Close** button in the Excel window, click the chart border to select the chart, click the **Chart Tools Design** tab, click the **More** button ▾ in the Chart Styles group, and then click **Style 26**.
6. Click the **Chart Tools Layout** tab, click the **Data Labels** button in the Labels group, click **More Data Label Options**, click the **Percentage** check box to select it, click the **Value** check box to deselect it, click the **Best Fit** option button in the Label Position area to select it if it is not selected, and then click **Close**.
7. Save the document.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)

- You add a caption to each figure in a document when you want to be able to generate a table of figures
  - By default, a caption contains the text *Figure* followed by caption number

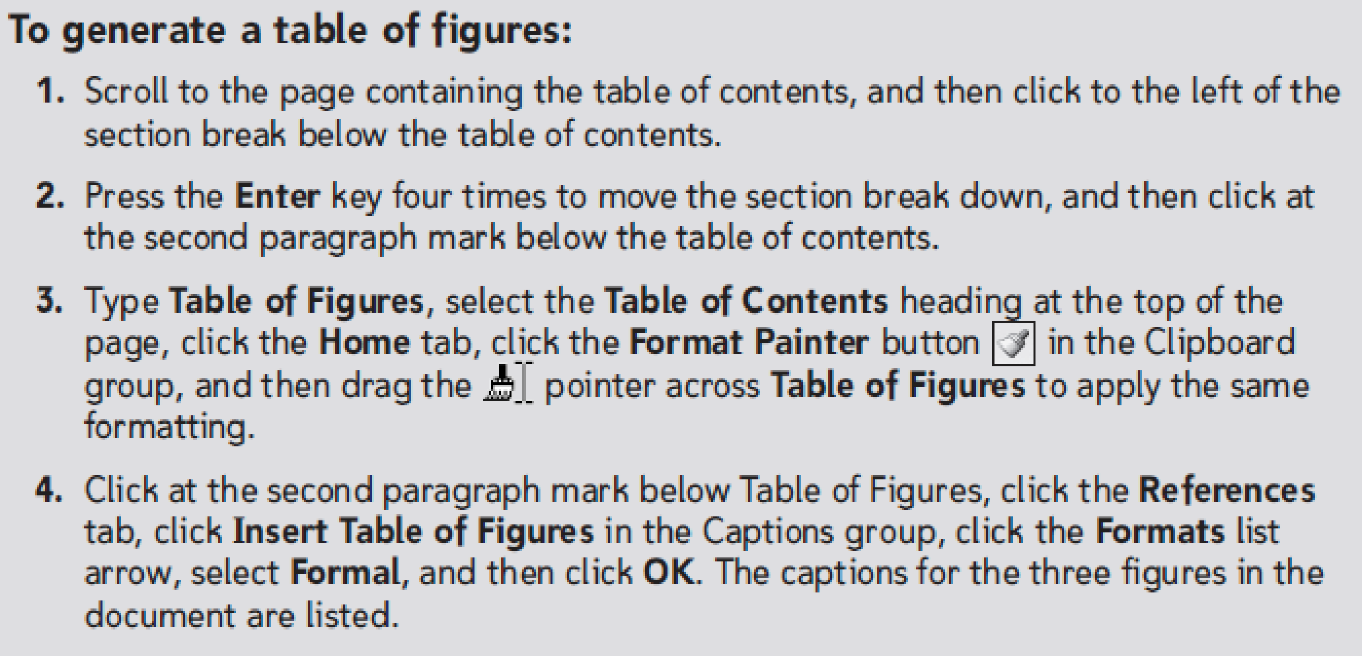


To add figure captions:

1. With the chart still selected, click the **References** tab, and then click **Insert Caption** in the Captions group. The insertion point appears after Figure 1 in the Caption dialog box.
2. Type a **colon** (:), press the **Spacebar**, type **Aromatherapy Sales**, and then click **OK**.
3. Scroll up to view the photograph in the New Marketing Image section, click the photograph, and then add a caption with the text: **Serenity’s New Look** following Figure 1. Note that Figure 1 is entered because the photograph precedes the pie chart in the document.
4. Scroll up to view the column chart, click the chart, and then add a caption with the text **Bath Products Sales** after Figure 1.
5. Save the document.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont'd.)

- A report that contains figures often includes a table of figures following table of contents
  - You can only generate a table of figures if you added captions



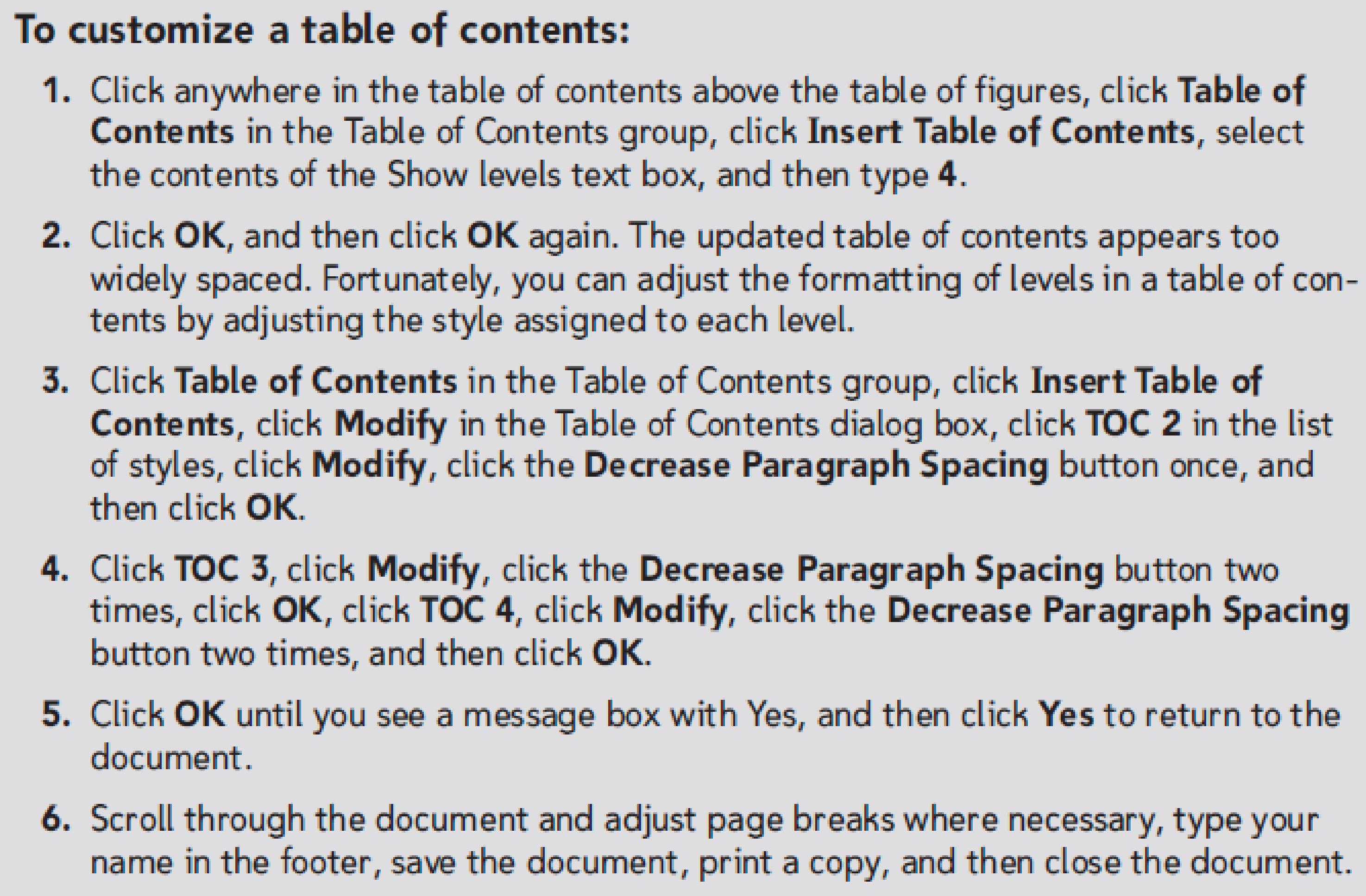
To generate a table of figures:

1. Scroll to the page containing the table of contents, and then click to the left of the section break below the table of contents.
2. Press the **Enter** key four times to move the section break down, and then click at the second paragraph mark below the table of contents.
3. Type **Table of Figures**, select the **Table of Contents** heading at the top of the page, click the **Home** tab, click the **Format Painter** button in the Clipboard group, and then drag the pointer across **Table of Figures** to apply the same formatting.
4. Click at the second paragraph mark below Table of Figures, click the **References** tab, click **Insert Table of Figures** in the Captions group, click the **Formats** list arrow, select **Formal**, and then click **OK**. The captions for the three figures in the document are listed.

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont’d.)

- You can customize a table of contents in a variety of ways
  - By default, a table of contents shows only three levels of headings
  - You can choose to show more levels and modify appearance of entries in the table of contents

Enhancing Multiple-Page Documents (cont'd.)



To customize a table of contents:

1. Click anywhere in the table of contents above the table of figures, click **Table of Contents** in the Table of Contents group, click **Insert Table of Contents**, select the contents of the Show levels text box, and then type **4**.
2. Click **OK**, and then click **OK** again. The updated table of contents appears too widely spaced. Fortunately, you can adjust the formatting of levels in a table of contents by adjusting the style assigned to each level.
3. Click **Table of Contents** in the Table of Contents group, click **Insert Table of Contents**, click **Modify** in the Table of Contents dialog box, click **TOC 2** in the list of styles, click **Modify**, click the **Decrease Paragraph Spacing** button once, and then click **OK**.
4. Click **TOC 3**, click **Modify**, click the **Decrease Paragraph Spacing** button two times, click **OK**, click **TOC 4**, click **Modify**, click the **Decrease Paragraph Spacing** button two times, and then click **OK**.
5. Click **OK** until you see a message box with Yes, and then click **Yes** to return to the document.
6. Scroll through the document and adjust page breaks where necessary, type your name in the footer, save the document, print a copy, and then close the document.